

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

What is an Idoru?



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about music, and being famous.
- I can talk hypothetically about the past.
- I can speculate about the past.

Ask your partner:

- What personalities do people idolize today?
- Are these personalities different from the ones idolized 15 years ago?





Let's Explore!

William Gibson* wrote a book called *Idoru*.

* "*William Gibson*" has been called the "noir prophet" of the cyberpunk subgenre.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

You may have heard that soon, your favorite pop stars may not be human. In fact, they may not even be alive. Would you have followed an *Idoru*, if they had become popular in your culture? Would you have put up a poster of them on your wall?

Might you have gone to see them projected as a hologram like Michael Jackson was after his death? Could you have considered marrying an *Idoru* if they had asked?

One of the most popular pop stars Japan has had is Kyoko. She has sung sweet pop songs on the radio to thousands of fans. She liked chocolate ice cream and American hamburgers. She had a boyfriend who played soccer for his high school team.

She seemed to be a perfectly normal teenager, except for the fact that she was a computer program. Kyoko's popularity in Japan has decreased over the years. If you had been young in the 90s you may have been part of her fan club. You may have dreamed of meeting her.

The concept of an *Idoru* has been developed even further by William Gibson in his novel of the same name. You might have read it. In the story a pop star named Rez has claimed to be married to the cyber pop star.

If this world had been real, it would have made a great TV series. However, so far it hasn't been possible. That is until the hologram of Michael Jackson popped up. The future looks interesting!



Let's Practice!

Let's learn about Kyoko.

Instructions: Read the text again. Select all the correct answers. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. "What does the man say about Kyoko?"

- ☐ Kyoko is a robot.
- ☐ Kyoko is still popular in Japan.
- ☐ She loved chocolate icecream.
- ☐ She had a lot of fans in the 80's.
- ☐ She had a boyfriend who played soccer.



Let's Practice!

It's time to find the mystery words.

Instructions: Read the words and find them in the wordsearch below. Use the words to write sentences. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Words

- the opposite of dead
- to cause an image to appear
- a special type image made with a laser in which an object looks solid
- ordinary or usual; the same as would be expected
- an organization for people who admire the same person

L	Y	N	F	Z	V	D	L	B	J	Z	M	F	H	G
U	N	L	I	L	W	Z	X	I	R	Q	F	X	I	C
K	P	C	C	A	Z	F	R	L	H	M	S	S	P	Y
W	A	N	P	G	C	Y	H	R	G	Q	Z	W	O	O
J	L	W	R	J	H	W	Q	Z	K	D	Q	Z	N	D
K	I	F	O	G	T	U	N	Y	Q	H	G	Z	F	W
D	V	F	J	O	K	Z	O	R	O	O	W	H	A	V
R	E	K	E	E	W	R	R	K	J	L	L	O	N	W
I	R	W	C	F	C	Q	M	Q	Z	O	P	P	C	P
J	N	Q	T	V	C	R	A	I	A	G	B	A	L	X
J	K	W	B	L	Z	K	L	U	O	R	P	W	U	Q
O	A	J	W	V	S	G	G	W	F	A	Q	U	B	F
O	N	G	I	R	B	H	G	G	E	M	F	X	C	J
F	E	E	W	E	C	O	L	F	T	M	M	Q	W	F
G	H	K	L	G	X	V	L	E	O	U	T	H	A	Y



Extension Activity

Create your own cyber celebrity!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about creating your own cyber celebrity and what type of person they would be.
- Decide what they would do, what they would look like, what they like, and who they would appeal to.
- Now tell someone about the celebrity using language to speculate in the past. (If you had been in Toronto in 2010, you might have heard about the Idoru there!)

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I create my own cyber celebrity.

☐ ☐

I decide what they would do, what they would look like, what they like, and who they would appeal to.

☐ ☐

I share the information about my celebrity in the past using the modal perfect.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **alive** (adjective): If something is alive, it continues to exist
e.g. In fact, they may not even be alive.
- **Idoru** (noun): a computer-generated media star, also a character in a science-fiction novel by the same name
e.g. William Gibson wrote a book called Idoru.
- **to project** (verb): to cause an image to appear
e.g. Might you have gone to see them projected as a hologram like Michael Jackson was after his death?
- **hologram** (noun): a special kind of picture that is produced by a laser and that looks three-dimensional
e.g. They cast the image of Michael Jackson as if it were real.
- **normal** (adjective): ordinary or usual
e.g. She seemed to be a perfectly normal teenager, except for the fact that she was a computer program.
- **to decrease** (verb): to become less, or to make something become less
e.g. Kyoko's popularity in Japan has decreased over the years.
- **fan club** (noun): an organization for people who admire the same singer, performer, football team, etc.
e.g. If you had been young in the 90s you may have been part of her fan club.
- **to pop up** (verb): to appear or happen, especially suddenly or unexpectedly
e.g. That is until the hologram of Michael Jackson popped up.





Learning Points

Talking Hypothetically and Speculating About the Past

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty and speculate about things in the past.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You use **could have** and **would have** to talk about things that were possible in the past and may or may not have happened (speculate).

You often use these structures with the third conditional.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

*You **may have heard** that soon, your favorite pop stars may not be human.*

- **May have** has a slightly stronger meaning than **might have** or **could have**.
- You can add **not** to make a negative speculation (It **may not have been** true).

You use **could have** to talk about possibilities if something had been different in the past.

For example:

***Could** you **have considered** marrying an Idoru if they had asked?*

You use **would have** to imagine a result if something had been different in the past.

For example:

***Would** you **have put up** a poster of them on your wall?*

Examples:

- *Would you have followed an Idoru, if they had become popular in your culture?*
- *Would you have put up a poster of them on your wall?*
- *Might you have gone to see them projected as a hologram like Michael Jackson was after his death?*
- *Could you have considered marrying an Idoru if they had asked?*
- *You may have dreamed of meeting her.*
- *You might have read it.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the **Simple Past tense** to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about experience. When you use the **Present Perfect tense**, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

*I **have learned** English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.
One of the most popular pop stars Japan **has had** is Kyoko.*

Usually, when you use the **Simple Past tense**, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

***Yesterday**, I **went** to the store.*

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence we would not use the **Present Perfect**. (~~*Yesterday, I have been to the store*~~).

Examples:

- *One of the most popular pop stars Japan **has had** is Kyoko.*
- *She **has sung** sweet pop songs on the radio to thousands of fans.*
- *She **liked** chocolate ice cream and American hamburgers.*
- *She **had** a boyfriend who played soccer for his high school team.*
- *She **seemed to be** a perfectly normal teenager, except for the fact that she was a computer program.*
- *She **gave** him a short hug and then stepped back to look at him.*

